

Αὐτοκράτης ὁ κωμικός

Autocrates the Comic Poet on Lydian Maidens

eul_aid: gzo

Period: Κλασική [Classical](#)
Dialect: Κωμωδία Ἀττική [Attic Comedy](#)
Domain: Κωμωδία [Comedy](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Autocrates was an Athenian comic poet active in the late 5th century BCE. He wrote in the tradition of Old Comedy, the same theatrical style as the famous playwright Aristophanes. According to the ancient Byzantine encyclopedia known as the Suda, he was producing plays around the time of the Peloponnesian War, specifically during the Olympiad of 412–409 BCE. Beyond this rough timeframe, no details of his life are recorded.

Ancient sources credit him with writing seven plays, but only two titles are known today, and both works are considered lost. The only play for which any text survives is Tympanistai, preserved in a single fragment. The other known title is Tunichos, for which no fragments exist. The subject of Tympanistai suggests his comedy might have touched on themes of ecstatic religious worship, a common subject for satire at the time.

Autocrates is a minor figure, but his documented existence is significant for understanding the breadth of Athenian theater. He represents one of the many comic poets whose work has been almost entirely lost, reminding us that the surviving complete plays from authors like Aristophanes are only a small part of a much richer and more diverse dramatic landscape.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Λυδῶν Κορῶν · [Fragments on Lydian Maidens](#) · 7 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Λυδῶν Κορῶν · [Fragments on Lydian Maidens](#) · 7 passages